What links the royal elegance of Rajasthan's Blue Pottery, the sweetness of Andhra Pradesh's Banganapalle Mango, the dance of Karnataka's Mysore Silk, and the tradition in Tripura Queen Pineapple? Artistry, Flavour, Silk, and Sweetness!

India's GI Mosaic Unravelled!

At the policy level, the government's discussions on framing a new scheme to modernize GIs highlight its dedication to aligning these products with the demands of both national and international markets. The collaboration with the Indian Institute of Packaging in Mumbai for training courses on innovative and attractive packaging is a commendable step toward ensuring the market competitiveness of GI products. The One District One Product (ODOP) initiative is a transformative stride toward achieving balanced regional development, aligning seamlessly with the Prime Minister's vision of 'Vocal for Local' and 'Local to Global'. By selecting, branding, and promoting one unique product from each district, ODOP is not only promoting socio-economic progress but also recognizing and celebrating the distinctive characteristics of each region. The comprehensive list of 761 products, including 80 GI products, showcases the close connection between local communities and their special products.

Under ODOP, the government has implemented various activities to promote GI products, such as Detailed Product Action Reports, Buyer-Seller Meets, and creating Market Linkages. These activities are crucial for facilitating trade, improving market access, and enhancing the visibility of GI goods globally. The emphasis on training and upskilling, along with showcasing and awareness creation through Brand Identity, further strengthens the foundation for sustainable growth of GI products. The initiatives taken by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) and various Export Promotion Council including setting up of the GI Pavilion at the recent India International Trade Fair 2023, which was inaugurated by the Hon'ble Union Minister of State for Commerce and Industry, Shri Som Parkash. It witnessed participation from more than 600 artisans from 28 States and Union Territories. This expansive showcase featured over 200 unique GI products spanning agriculture, food, handicrafts, and handloom. The engagement with international markets through events, buyer-seller meets, and promotional programs reflects a strategic approach to expand the reach of Indian GIs.



Geographical Indications are important as they create brand recognition, not just for the product or produce, but for the entire region. It has been seen that under certain conditions and encouragement, GI can contribute to immense development in rural and underdeveloped areas. Especially, because most of these products are usually made by communities and tribes living in rural and remote areas, so a boost to these will supplement the incomes of our rural artisans, weavers, craftsmen and farmers who sell these products in their respective local markets. With brand creation, it has been seen that they invariably contribute to employment generation and also adding impetus to tourism and related hospitality sectors. With GI, the entire region of a country gets a brand value and promoted in the process. For example, think of Champagne. Tourists visiting Europe make it a point to visit vineyards in the Champagne region of France, among other reasons, to taste the world's finest mood lifter in glass.

India stands as a testament to unparalleled cultural diversity and opulence, a mosaic of numerous tribes and communities, each adorned with distinctive arts, crafts, and handiwork. The country, blessed by the abundance of nature, encompasses an extensive array of plants, fruits, and crops, providing a fertile ground for the development of various geographical indications (GIs). Let us embark on a detailed exploration of some of India's remarkable GI products across North, West, South, East, and the North-East, each carving its niche on the global stage:

Northern Delights: A Tapestry of GI Treasures

India's Northern States & Union Territories unfold a vibrant canvas of Geographical Indication (GI) products, offering a glimpse into the region's unique heritage and craftsmanship. From the pristine fields of Kashmir to the high-altitude realms of Ladakh and Uttarakhand, these products not only contribute to economic growth but also serve as custodians of India's rich cultural legacy. Let's embark on a journey through the diverse tapestry of crafts, foods, and textiles, each intricately woven into the fabric of Northern India's distinctive heritage and environment:

